

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

Initial Determination and Partial-Release Cover Letter

Date: August 16, 2024 **Request:** DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041 **Production:** RLS-OG-001 **To:** Nila Quen, Open Grid Archive **From:** Elian Voss, fictional DOE FOIA Officer

ORER has completed its initial response to the clarified request. Searches located twelve responsive authoritative records comprising 200 logical source pages. Two governance records, totaling twenty-two pages, are released in full. Seven playbook records, totaling 124 pages, are released with redactions. Three operational records, totaling fifty-four pages, are withheld in full. The enclosed electronic production therefore contains 146 page images.

Of the produced images, sixty-eight display no blackout and seventy-eight display one or more redactions. Within those seventy-eight pages, sixty-two cite Exemption 7(E), fifty-one cite Exemption 7(F), and thirty-five cite both exemptions; the overlapping count is not additive. All fifty-four fully withheld pages cite 7(E), and thirty-nine of them also cite 7(F).

This response decides only the synthetic records described in the production manifest. It does not concern any live system or actual incident. The agency grants the fee waiver and assesses no charge. A fuller explanation of the search, exemptions, and appeal procedure follows.

Search and Production Summary

ORER assigned custodians on June 24 and began searches on June 25. Exports from the fictional Beacon, Driftglass, and Harborline repositories were complete on July 2. Automated deduplication ended July 12, and substantive review began July 22. Review closed August 12. The office used the agreed date, version, record-family, and exclusion rules rather than searching unrelated technical data.

The collection produced 16,842 raw search hits. Content and metadata deduplication reduced that number to 1,284 candidate files. Custodians then reviewed forty-six candidates that potentially met the finality and date tests. Twelve were responsive; the remainder were drafts, duplicates, routine transmittals, or outside the effective-date boundary.

Production RLS-OG-001 includes the two governance records in full and redacted copies of seven playbook records. The manifest lists three records withheld in full. A produced record retains its title, version, effective date, and nonexempt administrative context. The agency did not search event telemetry, source code, credentials, incident files, or real-infrastructure material because the clarification excluded them.

The office considers this search reasonably calculated to locate the agreed records. Its determination rests on the final set as maintained on the review date. A later-discovered responsive record would be processed consistently rather than ignored.

Exemption 7(E)

ORER determined that the responsive playbooks were compiled and used for a fictional law-enforcement purpose: preventing, recognizing, and coordinating a response to unlawful attacks on the synthetic Grid Sentinel environment. The office does not rely merely on the agency's general mission. It relies on the described function of the records and the custodian's certification that approved editions organize prevention and response decisions.

Exemption 7(E) is applied to nonpublic decision conditions, the order in which fictional response choices are evaluated, implementation sequences, and conditional branches. Even where a general preparedness concept is familiar, the office concludes that the particular organization and application of that concept within an approved decision tree is not public. Guideline fields are also withheld where revealing a fictional threshold or branch would permit a reader to anticipate when the suite changes its response classification.

The asserted harm is that disclosure could enable an actor to shape conduct around the suite's protected decision logic or frustrate an orderly response. This explanation does not reveal any protected value or sequence. The two governance records do not contain such operational details and are released in full. Portions of the other records that provide only general context are produced unless another exemption is asserted.

Exemption 7(F)

The office applies Exemption 7(F) to fields that it characterizes as identifying fictional duty roles, response contacts, safety references, and escalation positions. ORER concludes at a categorical level that exposing those fields could permit interference with personnel performing protective functions or could redirect attention toward a location associated with human safety. Personal names and real contact information are not part of this synthetic collection.

The same rationale is applied to each record containing one of those field types. In partially released records, a 7(F) notation appears beside the affected blackout. In fully withheld records, the production manifest identifies whether the exemption overlaps with 7(E). The office does not identify a threatened individual by name and does not describe a particular incident; it treats the role and safety categories as sufficient to show an expected risk.

Some passages carry both exemptions because the agency views a fictional duty assignment as part of an operational sequence and as related to physical safety. The two bases are recorded separately even when the same words are removed. The determination does not invoke 7(F) for ordinary approval dates, version numbers, or general program descriptions, which remain visible where they can be separated from the protected field.

Foreseeable Harm and Segregability

Reviewers considered whether disclosure would foreseeably harm the interests protected by the cited exemptions. For 7(E), ORER predicts interference with the effectiveness of the fictional response framework if a reader could reconstruct protected conditions and branch order. For 7(F), it predicts increased danger if protected role, contact, or safety-location fields were exposed. These predictions are based on the record categories and the custodian's assessment.

The office states that each responsive page was examined for segregability. It released titles, dates, revision identifiers, general purpose language, administrative headings, and governance text when reviewers believed those portions could be understood apart from protected details. It withheld entire records when the operational organization was viewed as continuous and when separating individual words was considered likely to reveal the protected structure.

No further reasonably segregable information is identified. The agency's conclusion is stated for the reviewed categories as a whole; the production manifest does not provide a line-by-line explanation for every retained blackout. The office will reconsider particular passages on administrative appeal if Open Grid identifies a concrete disputed record or administrative field. The foreseeable-harm and segregation findings are independent of the earlier scope exclusions.

Record Dispositions and Appeal Rights

The twelve records are grouped as follows: four decision-tree records totaling sixty pages; three escalation-matrix records totaling fifty-four pages; three coordination appendices totaling sixty-four pages; and two governance records totaling twenty-two pages. Decision-tree editions GS-DT-4.2 and GS-DT-3.7 and current matrix GS-EM-4.2 are withheld in full, totaling fifty-four pages. Seven other playbook records are partially released. Governance records GS-GV-04 and GS-GV-03 are released without redaction.

Open Grid may appeal this determination by writing to the fictional DOE Office of Public Access Review within ninety calendar days. The appeal should identify DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041, specify the disputed withholding or search issue, and include this letter. Electronic submission is acceptable. The appeal office is separate from ORER for purposes of this exercise.

The enclosed manifest and production are deemed transmitted on August 16, 2024. Elian Voss certifies that the arithmetic in this letter counts logical source pages once; it does not count a later public and sealed litigation copy as separate responsive material. Nothing in the letter supplies operational cyber instructions, and every program identifier is fictional.

Elian Voss FOIA Officer, fictional DOE Office of Resilience Exercise Records